Lesson notes · for you

How a chatbot writes

AI · Level 2 · Lesson 1

Time
25 min

Materials
A notebook and pen; A friend or family member for the word game; A phone with the Darsi app (for the lab)

Learning goals

- Explain how a chatbot writes, one likely piece at a time.
- Say why it can sound sure and still be wrong.
- Explain why it may know less about your country and language.

Activity: One word each

1. Warm-up (3 min): On any phone, type “Our town is” and tap the keyboard’s middle suggestion ten times. Read the sentence aloud: is it fluent? Is it true? The keyboard picks likely words, not true ones.
2. Recall (5 min): Without looking, write the steps a chatbot repeats to build an answer: look at the text so far, score every possible next token, pick a likely one and add it, then repeat. Check your list against the Remember slide.
3. Word game (8 min): In pairs or threes, start with “One day at school”. Take turns adding the single most likely next word, without planning ahead, until the story reaches twenty words.
4. Spot the drift (5 min): Read the story aloud. Underline the word where it started to go wrong or stopped making sense, and talk about why: each word was likely, but nobody checked the whole story.
5. Wrap-up (4 min): Each person writes one way the game is like a chatbot and one way it isn’t: for example, you know what is true, while a chatbot only knows what is likely.

For a group of friends, or at home with your family. You need paper and a pen; a phone is only needed for the warm-up.

Discussion

- Where have you seen a phone or app predict your next word?
- Why can a smooth, confident answer still be wrong?
- What might a chatbot know less about in your country or language?

Check yourself

- In one sentence: how does a chatbot write, and why does that mean you should check it?

Try it this week
Play “One word each” with a friend: take turns adding the most likely next word to a story, without planning ahead. Stop at twenty words, read it aloud, and find where it started to go wrong.

Worksheet

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **Mr Joseph trained a tiny language model on 16 sentences about school. He asks it to write a story about the market. What happens?**

- ◯ It looks up market words online
- ◯ It writes a true story about a real market
- ◯ It asks Mr Joseph for more sentences
- ◯ It can't: it learned no sentences about a market

2 **A chatbot looks up each fact in a big library before it writes it.**

- ◯ True
- ◯ False

3 **Put in order how a chatbot writes its answer.**

- ☐ It repeats until the answer is finished
- ☐ It picks a likely token and adds it
- ☐ It scores every possible next token
- ☐ It looks at everything written so far
- ☐ You type a message

4 **Why might a chatbot get things wrong about your town? Choose all that are true.**

- ☐ Much less has been written online about small towns
- ☐ Less text online is in many local languages
- ☐ Its training text ends on a fixed date, so recent news can be missing
- ☐ Chatbots are told to ignore small towns
- ☐ It deletes small places to save space

5 **Complete the sentence.**

A chatbot writes one _____ at a time, choosing a _____ next piece, so its answers can sound _____ and still be wrong.

Word bank: token · likely · fluent · line · checked

✎ **Think of a time a phone, a translator or a chatbot wrote something that sounded right but wasn't. What happened, and why do you think it happened?**